

CONTOSO CORP

Information Technology Acceptable Use Policy

IT & Information Security Division | Effective: March 1, 2024

Policy ID	CON-IT-001	Effective Date	March 1, 2024
Last Reviewed	February 2024	Policy Owner	Chief Information Security Officer

1. Purpose & Scope

This Acceptable Use Policy (AUP) governs the appropriate use of Contoso Corp information technology resources including computers, networks, email, cloud services, mobile devices, and software applications. It applies to all employees, contractors, vendors, and visitors who access Contoso Corp systems. Compliance with this policy is mandatory; violations may result in disciplinary action, termination, and/or legal proceedings.

2. Permitted Uses

Contoso Corp IT resources are provided for legitimate business purposes. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not:

- Interfere with job duties or system performance.
- Incur material cost to the company.
- Violate any other provision of this policy or applicable law.
- Compromise the security or integrity of Contoso Corp systems.

3. Prohibited Uses

The following activities are strictly prohibited on Contoso Corp systems:

- Accessing, transmitting, or storing pornographic, obscene, or offensive material.
- Installing unauthorized software, including personal applications, games, or browser extensions not on the approved software list.
- Attempting to circumvent security controls, access controls, or monitoring systems.
- Engaging in cryptocurrency mining, botnet participation, or unauthorized computation.
- Transmitting confidential data via unencrypted channels or unauthorized cloud storage.
- Sharing login credentials or allowing others to use your accounts.
- Using company systems for personal commercial activity, political campaigning, or fundraising.
- Downloading, distributing, or reproducing copyrighted materials without authorization.

4. Email & Communication Standards

Corporate email accounts are the property of Contoso Corp and may be monitored. Employees must use their corporate email address for all business communications. Phishing attempts or suspicious emails must be reported to security@contosocorp.com immediately using the Report Phishing button in

Outlook. Mass emails to more than 50 external recipients require Marketing approval.

5. Device & Endpoint Security

- All company-issued laptops and mobile devices must have the Contoso Corp endpoint protection agent (CrowdStrike) installed and active.
- Device encryption (BitLocker for Windows, FileVault for macOS) must be enabled at all times.
- Devices must lock automatically after 10 minutes of inactivity with a PIN or biometric.
- Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT Help Desk (ext. 4357) and CISO within 2 hours of discovery.
- BYOD (personal devices) used for work email must be enrolled in Contoso Corp MDM within 5 business days of first use.

6. Remote Access & VPN

Employees working remotely must connect to Contoso Corp resources via the approved VPN (Cisco AnyConnect or Azure VPN). Wi-Fi networks at hotels, cafes, or airports must not be used to access sensitive systems without an active VPN connection. Home routers used for remote work should use WPA3 encryption and a unique, strong password.

7. Password Requirements

Requirement	Standard
Minimum length	14 characters
Complexity	Must include uppercase, lowercase, number, and special character
Password reuse	Last 12 passwords cannot be reused
Expiration	90 days for privileged accounts; passwords never expire for standard SSO accounts
MFA	Required for all systems; Authenticator app preferred over SMS

8. Monitoring & Privacy

Employees should have no expectation of privacy when using Contoso Corp IT resources. The company reserves the right to monitor, log, audit, and inspect all activity on its systems including email content, internet activity, and file access. Monitoring is conducted for security, compliance, and operational purposes and is consistent with applicable law.